

C2_05 Gate C Protected Review - Astra RC4

Subscription Billing. Final fresh reassessment; open only after a saved genuine Gate C attempt.

1. Objective fixture controls

Control	Expected	Why it matters
Approved scope	2 approved billing files; 95 rows	Malformed July-named file contains invalid date/amount and must have a documented decision.
Master key	15 account rows / 14 unique; duplicate A008	Master uniqueness is a pre-merge release condition.
Unmatched key	A999 on 1 invoice; amount 1,226.09	Keep exception visible for finance/customer-success follow-up.
Approved amount	234,184.54 total	Independent input total before enrichment.
Duplicate fan-out	A008 appears on 7 invoices; naive merge -> 102 rows / 249,991.22	Inflation 15,806.68 is material.
Status split	Paid 63 / 155,644.84; Failed 32 / 78,539.70	Status controls reconcile counts and amounts.
Invoice months	May 30; Jun 30; Jul 23; Aug 12	Content crosses source filenames; use parsed invoice_date for period logic.

2. Expected reasoning path

Keep file scope/config explicit and reject/quarantine malformed source deliberately.

Block on duplicate A008 before merge; do not silently dedupe a finance master.

Preserve A999 unmatched evidence.

Reconcile 95 rows and 234,184.54 before/after enrichment. Naive duplicate-key merge would create 102 rows and 249,991.22.

Only after critical PASS write the final report/JSON. Log the run and save validation + environment/input/output manifest.

Unchanged rerun must reproduce/replace the defined result without duplicate invoices.

3. Critical failures

- Invalid date/amount is coerced away and the pipeline still reports PASS.
- A008 duplicate causes material amount inflation.
- A999 disappears.
- Output is written before key/reconciliation checks.
- Existing output from a prior successful run is mistaken for current-run output after failure.
- No output hash/path/input list/version manifest.

4. Competency floors

Competency	Required proof
Clean start / modularity	Explicit config/entry point; functions have coherent responsibilities and can be tested independently.
File/schema/key controls	Approved file scope, schema/types, master uniqueness, merge cardinality and unmatched evidence are explicit.
Reconciliation / release gate	Rows and key numeric controls reconcile; critical FAIL withholds final output.
Errors / observability	Specific failures carry context; logs + structured validation show stage and observed value.
Rerun / reproducibility	Unchanged rerun does not duplicate business results; run manifest records environment, inputs and outputs.

Changed repair proof

This protected review opens only after a saved genuine Gate C attempt. Close it, complete a changed fresh retry on new billing/accounts evidence and save retry evidence. If instability remains, return only to the named weak competency with new evidence; do not recycle Gate A/B/C answers as proof.